

what factors hindered the realization of the goal to double farmers' income?

We face several challenges in following the norms envisaged for a Viksit Bharat and doubling farmers' income:

1. Lack of Fair Pricing and Market Freedom:

Farmers still lack the freedom to sell their produce wherever they choose, unlike other sectors. While the government introduced reforms like the three farm laws to enable farmers to sell outside APMCs and engage in contract farming, these were withdrawn under pressure from certain activist groups. This limits farmers' ability to secure fair prices and attract rural youth in the agriculture sector.

2. Quality Inputs and Enforcement Issues: The availability of quality agricultural inputs, including fertilizers, pesticides, and seeds, is still a challenge due to inadequate enforcement of existing laws. For instance, in 2021, in Karnataka, 250 samples of so-called bio-pesticides were found to be adulterated with up to 12 chemicals, even some unregistered in India. Despite this, no action was taken against the culprits. Sampling procedures intended to ensure quality are often focused on the top 50-60 reputed companies, leaving smaller operators and illegal suppliers scot-free, further cheating farmers.

3. Limited Access to Modern Technologies: Over 85% of small and marginal farmers in India still lack access to new technologies such as IT, IoT, drones, and precision agriculture. These technologies are crucial for improving productivity, reducing costs,

and enhancing farm sustainability.

Such challenges need to be addressed to unlock the true potential of Indian agriculture and achieve the goal of doubling farmers' income.

What role do you envision for the government, particularly the Department of Agriculture, in driving agricultural growth and addressing the sector's challenges? What are your key expectations from this department?

The government, under the leadership of Shri Shivraj Singh Chauhan and Secretary Shri Devesh Chaturvedi, has been actively pursuing agricultural reforms, and I believe their efforts will significantly address the sector's challenges. For example, the recent cancellation of 7,000 fraudulent company registrations by the Ministry marks a positive step towards reform. Additionally, digitization efforts at CIB&RC are progressing, which will help ensure better regulatory oversight.

However, there is still a pressing need for further reforms. As a signatory to the WTO and TRIPS, India should introduce data protection laws that are already in place globally. Our country currently has only 339 pesticide molecules registered, compared to over 1,200 worldwide, highlighting the urgent need for newer molecules. This will empower farmers to combat new pests, especially those driven by climate change.

In conclusion, I expect the Ministry of Agriculture and its associated bodies to ensure the effective implementation of the Insecticides Act of 1968 and the rules of 1971, so that farmers have access to

modern, safe, and effective agricultural inputs.

Dhanuka has made significant strides in the agricultural sector, benefiting farmers and the agricultural ecosystem. Could you share some of the key initiatives where Dhanuka is also contributing to the broader welfare of society beyond agriculture?

Since its inception, Dhanuka Agritech has been committed to community development through various social initiatives, focusing on education, water conservation, healthcare, and environmental sustainability. The company believes education is the most powerful tool for societal transformation, exemplified by the establishment of schools like Shrimati Triveni Devi Dhanuka Higher Secondary Adarsh Vidya Mandir in Rajasthan, and various others, providing quality education to underserved communities. Dhanuka has also been proactive in water conservation, constructing check dams, rejuvenating ponds, and establishing community water centers to ensure sustainable water management. Additionally, the company has organized medical camps, offering crucial healthcare services, distributing medical aids, spectacles, and conducting surgeries to improve the health and well-being of thousands across India. Most recently, we have built a waiting hall at AIIMS, New Delhi for the patients and their relatives as there was no such facilities at AIIMS earlier. These initiatives reflect Dhanuka's ongoing commitment to creating lasting social value by addressing essential needs and improving the quality of life for communities.



Mr. Mahendra Kumar Dhanuka
Chairman, Dhanuka Agritech



Mr. Rahul Dhanuka
MD, Dhanuka Agritech

What are Dhanuka's future management strategies and plans for nurturing internal leadership?

Having retired from day-to-day operations, I now serve as Chairman Emeritus. As part of our succession planning, Mr. Mahendra Kumar Dhanuka has taken on the role of Chairman of Dhanuka Agritech, while Mr. Rahul Dhanuka will serve as Managing Director of Dhanuka Agritech. I am confident that under their leadership, Dhanuka will reach new heights and continue to thrive in the industry.